

Pharmacy and prescriptions

The hospital pharmacy is on the ground floor of the Green Zone, immediately past outpatient reception.

Opening hours

The pharmacy is open Monday to Friday from 09:00 to 18:00, and on Saturday from 09:00 to 13:00. It is closed on Sundays and bank holidays.

Outside these hours, ward patients are supplied by the on-call pharmacist through the nurse in charge. Ask the ward, not the pharmacy counter.

Take-home medicines

When you are discharged, the ward sends your prescription to the pharmacy electronically. Dispensing takes between one and three hours depending on how busy the department is, and this is the single most common reason people wait to go home.

You may wait in the discharge lounge on the ground floor of the Blue Zone. The pharmacy will telephone the lounge when your medicines are ready.

Prescription charges

Medicines given to you while you are an inpatient are free.

Take-home medicines and outpatient prescriptions are charged at the standard NHS prescription rate, per item.

You do not pay if you are under sixteen, aged sixteen to eighteen and in full-time education, over sixty, hold a valid medical or maternity exemption certificate, or hold a prepayment certificate. Bring the certificate with you.

Repeat prescriptions

The hospital does not issue repeat prescriptions. After your first supply, your GP takes over. The discharge summary sent to your GP lists everything you were given and for how long.

Contact your GP practice about three days before your supply runs out.

Bringing your own medicines

Bring every medicine you take in its original box, including inhalers, eye drops, creams, herbal remedies, and anything bought over the counter.

Your own medicines are checked by a pharmacist and, if they are suitable, used during your stay and returned to you when you leave.

Questions about your medicines

The medicines information line is 020 7946 0170, open 09:00 to 17:00 on weekdays. A pharmacist can explain what a medicine is for, how to take it, and what the common side effects are.

If you think you are having a serious reaction to a medicine, do not wait for the information line. Contact your GP urgently, or in an emergency call 999.